14 Then all the officials sent word to Baruch through Jehudi son of Nethaniah, the
son of Shelemiah, the son of Cushi, saying, "Bring the scroll that you read in the
hearing of the people, and come here." So Baruch son of Neriah took the scroll
and went to them. 15 "Please sit down," they said, "and read it in our hearing." So
Baruch read it in their hearing. 16 When they had heard all these words, they turned
to one another in fear and said to Baruch, "Surely we must report all these words to
the king." 17 "Tell us now," they asked Baruch, "how did you write all these words?
Was it at Jeremiah's dictation?" 18 "It was at his dictation," Baruch replied. "He
recited all these words to me and I wrote them in ink on the scroll." 19 Then the
officials said to Baruch, "You and Jeremiah must hide yourselves and tell no one
where you are." 20 So the officials went to the king in the courtyard. And having
stored the scroll in the chamber of Elishama the scribe, they reported everything
to the king.

21 Then the king sent Jehudi to get the scroll, and he took it from the chamber
of Elishama the scribe. And Jehudi read it in the hearing of the king and all the
officials who were standing beside him. 22 Since it was the ninth month, the king
was sitting in his winter quarters with a fire burning before him. 23 And as soon as
Jehudi had read three or four columns, Jehoiakim would cut them off with a scribe's
knife and throw them into the firepot, until the entire scroll had been consumed by
the fire. 24 Yet in hearing all these words, the king and his servants did not become
frightened or tear their garments. 25 Even though Elnathan, Delaiah, and Gemariah
urged the king not to burn the scroll, he would not listen to them. 26 Instead, the
king commanded Jerahmeel, a son of the king, as well as Seraiah son of Azriel and
Shelemiah son of Abdeel, to seize Baruch the scribe and Jeremiah the prophet. But
the LORD had hidden them. 27 After the king had burned the scroll containing
the words that Baruch had written at Jeremiah's dictation, the word of the LORD
came to Jeremiah: 28 "Take another scroll and rewrite on it the very words that were
on the original scroll, which Jehoiakim king of Judah has burned." 29 You are to
proclaim concerning Jehoiakim king of Judah that this is what the LORD says:
You have burned the scroll and said, 'Why have you written on it that the king of
Babylon would surely come and destroy this land and deprive it of man and beast?'
30 Therefore this is what the LORD says about Jehoiakim king of Judah: He will
have no one to sit on David's throne, and his body will be thrown out and exposed
to heat by day and frost by night. 31 "I will punish him and his descendants and
servants for their iniquity. I will bring on them, on the residents of Jerusalem, and
on the men of Judah, all the calamity about which I warned them but they did
not listen." 32 Then Jeremiah took another scroll and gave it to the scribe Baruch
son of Neriah, and at Jeremiah's dictation he wrote on it all the words of the scroll
that Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire. And many similar words were
added to them.

37 Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon made Zedekiah son of Josiah the king of
Judah, and he reigned in place of Coniah son of Jehoiakim. 2 But he and his officers
and the people of the land refused to obey the words that the LORD had spoken
through Jeremiah the prophet. 3 Yet King Zedekiah sent Jehucal son of Shelemiah
and Zephaniah the priest, the son of Maaseiah, to Jeremiah the prophet with the
message, "Please pray to the LORD our God for us!" 4 Now Jeremiah was free to
come and go among the people, for they had not yet put him in prison. 5 Pharaoh's
army had left Egypt, and when the Chaldeans who were besieging Jerusalem heard
the report, they withdrew from Jerusalem. 6 Then the word of the LORD came
to Jeremiah the prophet: 7 "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says that
you are to tell the king of Judah, who sent you to Me: Behold, Pharaoh's army,
which has marched out to help you, will go back to its own land of Egypt." 8 Then
the Chaldeans will return and fight against this city. They will capture it and burn
it down.

9 This is what the LORD says: Do not deceive yourselves by saying, 'The
Chaldeans will go away for good,' for they will not! 10 "Indeed, if you were to
strike down the entire army of the Chaldeans that is fighting against you, and
only wounded men remained in their tents, they would still get up and burn this
city down." 11 When the Chaldean army withdrew from Jerusalem for fear of
Pharaoh's army, 12 Jeremiah started to leave Jerusalem to go to the land of Benjamin
to claim his portion there among the people. 13 But when he reached the Gate of
Benjamin, the captain of the guard, whose name was Irijah son of Shelemiah, the
son of Hananiah, seized him and said, "You are deserting to the Chaldeans!"

14 "That is a lie," Jeremiah replied. "I am not deserting to the Chaldeans!" But Irijah
would not listen to him; instead, he arrested Jeremiah and took him to the officials.
15 The officials were angry with Jeremiah, and they beat him and placed him in
jail in the house of Jonathan the scribe, for it had been made into a prison. 16 So
Jeremiah went into a cell in the dungeon and remained there a long time. 17 Later,
King Zedekiah sent for Jeremiah and received him in his palace, where he asked him
privately, "Is there a word from the LORD?" "There is," Jeremiah replied. "You will
be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon." 18 Then Jeremiah asked King
Zedekiah, "How have I sinned against you or your servants or these people, that
you have put me in prison?" 19 Where are your prophets who prophesied to you,
claiming, 'The king of Babylon will not come against you or this land'? 20 "But now
please listen, O my lord the king. May my petition come before you. Do not send
me back to the house of Jonathan the scribe, or I will die there." 21 So King Zedekiah
gave orders for Jeremiah to be placed in the courtyard of the guard and given a loaf
of bread daily from the street of the bakers, until all the bread in the city was gone.
So Jeremiah remained in the courtyard of the guard.

38 Now Shephatiah son of Mattan, Gedaliah son of Pashhur, Jucal son of
Shelemiah, and Pashhur son of Malchijah heard that Jeremiah had been telling all
the people: 2 "This is what the LORD says: Whoever stays in this city will die by
sword and famine and plague, but whoever surrenders to the Chaldeans will live; he
will retain his life like a spoil of war, and he will live." 3 "This is what the LORD says:
This city will surely be delivered into the hands of the army of the king of Babylon,
and he will capture it." 4 Then the officials said to the king, "This man ought to die,
for he is discouraging the warriors who remain in this city, as well as all the people,
by speaking such words to them; this man is not seeking the well-being of these
people, but their ruin." 5 "Here he is," replied King Zedekiah. "He is in your hands,
since the king can do nothing to stop you." 6 So they took Jeremiah and dropped
him into the cistern of Malchiah, the king's son, which was in the courtyard of the
guard. They lowered Jeremiah with ropes into the cistern, which had no water but
only mud, and Jeremiah sank down into the mud. 7 Now Ebed-melech the Cushite,
a court official in the royal palace, heard that Jeremiah had been put into the cistern.
While the king was sitting at the Gate of Benjamin, 8 Ebed-melech went out from
the king's palace and said to the king, 9 "My lord the king, these men have acted
wickedly in all that they have done to Jeremiah the prophet. They have dropped
him into the cistern, where he will starve to death, for there is no more bread in
the city." 10 So the king commanded Ebed-melech the Cushite, "Take thirty men
from here with you and pull Jeremiah the prophet out of the cistern before he dies."
11 Then Ebed-melech took the men with him and went to the king's palace, to a
place below the storehouse. From there he took old rags and worn-out clothes and
lowered them with ropes to Jeremiah in the cistern.

12 Ebed-melech the Cushite cried out to Jeremiah, "Put these worn-out rags and
clothes under your arms to pad the ropes." Jeremiah did so, 13 and they pulled him
up with the ropes and lifted him out of the cistern. And Jeremiah remained in the
courtyard of the guard. 14 Then King Zedekiah sent for Jeremiah the prophet and
received him at the third entrance to the house of the LORD. "I am going to ask
you something," said the king to Jeremiah. "Do not hide anything from me." 15 "If
I tell you," Jeremiah replied, "you will surely put me to death. And even if I give you
advice, you will not listen to me." 16 But King Zedekiah swore secretly to Jeremiah,
"As surely as the LORD lives, who has given us this life, I will not kill you, nor will I
deliver you into the hands of these men who are seeking your life." 17 Then Jeremiah
said to Zedekiah, "This is what the LORD God of Hosts, the God of Israel, says:
'If you indeed surrender to the officers of the king of Babylon, then you will live,
this city will not be burned down, and you and your household will survive.'"

18 "But if you do not surrender to the officers of the king of Babylon, then this city
will be delivered into the hands of the Chaldeans. They will burn it down, and
you yourself will not escape their grasp.'" 19 But King Zedekiah said to Jeremiah, "I
am afraid of the Jews who have deserted to the Chaldeans, for the Chaldeans may
deliver me into their hands to abuse me." 20 "They will not hand you over," Jeremiah
replied. "Obey the voice of the LORD in what I am telling you, that it may go well
with you and you may live." 21 But if you refuse to surrender, this is the word that
the LORD has shown me: 22 All the women who remain in the palace of the king of
Judah will be brought out to the officials of the king of Babylon, and those women
will say: 'They misled you and overcame you— those trusted friends of yours. Your
feet sank into the mire, and they deserted you.' 23 "All your wives and children will be
brought out to the Chaldeans. And you yourself will not escape their grasp, for you
will be seized by the king of Babylon, and this city will be burned down." 24 Then
Zedekiah warned Jeremiah, "Do not let anyone know about this conversation, or
you will die." 25 If the officials hear that I have spoken with you, and they come and
demand of you, 'Tell us what you said to the king and what he said to you; do not
hide it from us, or we will kill you,' 26 "then tell them, 'I was presenting to the king
my petition that he not return me to the house of Jonathan to die there.'" 27 When
all the officials came to Jeremiah and questioned him, he relayed to them the exact
words the king had commanded him to say. So they said no more to him, for no
one had overheard the conversation. 28 And Jeremiah remained in the courtyard of
the guard until the day Jerusalem was captured.

39 In the ninth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, in the tenth month,
Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon marched against Jerusalem with his entire army
and laid siege to the city. 2 And on the ninth day of the fourth month of Zedekiah's
eleventh year, the city was breached. 3 Then all the officials of the king of Babylon
entered and sat in the Middle Gate: Nergal-sharezer of Samgar, Nebo-sarsekim the
Rabsaris, Nergal-sharezer the Rabmag, and all the rest of the officials of the king
of Babylon. 4 When Zedekiah king of Judah and all the soldiers saw them, they fled.
They left the city at night by way of the king's garden, through the gate between
the two walls, and they went out along the route to the Arabah. 5 But the army of
the Chaldeans pursued them and overtook Zedekiah in the plains of Jericho. They

seized him and brought him up to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon at Riblah in the land of Hamath, where he pronounced judgment on him. [6] There at Riblah the king of Babylon slaughtered the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes, and he also killed all the nobles of Judah. [7] Then he put out Zedekiah's eyes and bound him with bronze chains to take him to Babylon. [8] The Chaldeans set fire to the palace of the king and to the houses of the people, and they broke down the walls of Jerusalem.

[9] Then Nebuzaradan captain of the guard carried away to Babylon the remnant of the people who had remained in the city, along with the deserters who had defected to him. [10] But Nebuzaradan left behind in the land of Judah some of the poor people who had no property, and at that time he gave them vineyards and fields. [11] Now Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had given orders about Jeremiah through Nebuzaradan captain of the guard, saying, [12] "Take him, look after him, and do not let any harm come to him; do for him whatever he says." [13] So Nebuzaradan captain of the guard, Nebushazban the Rabsaris, Nergal-sharezer the Rabmag, and all the captains of the king of Babylon [14] had Jeremiah brought from the courtyard of the guard, and they turned him over to Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, to take him home. So Jeremiah remained among his own people. [15] And while Jeremiah had been confined in the courtyard of the guard, the word of the LORD had come to him: [16] "Go and tell Ebed-melech the Cushite that this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'I am about to fulfill My words against this city for harm and not for good, and on that day they will be fulfilled before your eyes.'" [17] But I will deliver you on that day, declares the LORD, and you will not be delivered into the hands of the men whom you fear. [18] "For I will surely rescue you so that you do not fall by the sword. Because you have trusted in Me, you will escape with your life like a spoil of war, declares the LORD.'"

40 This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD after Nebuzaradan captain of the guard had released him at Ramah, having found him bound in chains among all the captives of Jerusalem and Judah who were being exiled to Babylon. [2] The captain of the guard found Jeremiah and said to him, "The LORD your God decreed this disaster on this place," [3] and now the LORD has fulfilled it; He has done just as He said. Because you people have sinned against the LORD and have not obeyed His voice, this thing has happened to you. [4] "But now, behold, I am freeing you today from the chains that were on your wrists. If it pleases you to come with me to Babylon, then come, and I will take care of you. But if it seems wrong to you to come with me to Babylon, go no farther. Look, the whole land is before you. Wherever it seems good and right to you, go there." [5] But before Jeremiah turned to go, Nebuzaradan added, "Return to Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, whom the king of Babylon has appointed over the cities of Judah, and stay with him among the people, or go anywhere else that seems right." Then the captain of the guard gave him a ration and a gift and released him. [6] So Jeremiah went to Gedaliah son of Ahikam at Mizpah and stayed with him among the people who were left in the land. [7] When all the commanders and men of the armies in the field heard that the king of Babylon had appointed Gedaliah son of Ahikam over the land and that he had put him in charge of the men, women, and children who were the poorest of the land and had not been exiled to Babylon, [8] they came to Gedaliah at Mizpah —Ishmael son of Nethaniah, Johanan and Jonathan the sons of Kareah, Seraiah son of Tanhumeth, the sons of Ephai the Netophathite, and Jezaniah son of the Maacathite—they and their men.

[9] Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, swore an oath to them and their men, assuring them, "Do not be afraid to serve the Chaldeans. Live in the land and serve the king of Babylon, and it will go well with you." [10] "As for me, I will stay in Mizpah to represent you before the Chaldeans who come to us. As for you, gather wine grapes, summer fruit, and oil, place them in your storage jars, and live in the cities you have taken." [11] When all the Jews in Moab, Ammon, Edom, and all the other lands heard that the king of Babylon had left a remnant in Judah and had appointed Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, over them, [12] they all returned from all the places to which they had been banished and came to the land of Judah, to Gedaliah at Mizpah. And they gathered an abundance of wine grapes and summer fruit. [13] Meanwhile, Johanan son of Kareah and all the commanders of the armies in the field came to Gedaliah at Mizpah [14] and said to him, "Are you aware that Baalis king of the Ammonites has sent Ishmael son of Nethaniah to take your life?" But Gedaliah son of Ahikam did not believe them. [15] Then Johanan son of Kareah spoke privately to Gedaliah at Mizpah. "Let me go and kill Ishmael son of Nethaniah," he said. "No one will know it. Why should he take your life and scatter all the people of Judah who have gathered to you, so that the remnant of Judah would perish?" [16] But Gedaliah son of Ahikam said to Johanan son of Kareah, "Do not do such a thing! What you are saying about Ishmael is a lie."

41 In the seventh month, Ishmael son of Nethaniah, the son of Elishama, who was a member of the royal family and one of the king's chief officers, came with ten men to Gedaliah son of Ahikam at Mizpah, and they ate a meal together there. [2] Then Ishmael son of Nethaniah and the ten men who were with him got up and struck down Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, with the sword, killing the one whom the king of Babylon had appointed to govern the land. [3] Ishmael also killed all the Jews who were with Gedaliah at Mizpah, as well as the Chaldean soldiers who were there. [4] On the second day after the murder of Gedaliah, when no one yet knew about it, [5] eighty men who had shaved off their beards, torn their garments, and cut themselves came from Shechem, Shiloh, and Samaria, carrying grain offerings and frankincense for the house of the LORD. [6] And Ishmael son of Nethaniah went out from Mizpah to meet them, weeping as he went. When Ishmael encountered the men, he said, "Come to Gedaliah son of Ahikam." [7] And when they came into the city, Ishmael son of Nethaniah and the men with him slaughtered them and threw them into a cistern. [8] But ten of the men among them said to Ishmael, "Do not kill us, for we have hidden treasure in the field—wheat, barley, oil, and honey!" So he refrained from killing them with the others. [9] Now the cistern into which Ishmael had thrown all the bodies of the men he had struck down along with Gedaliah was a large one that King Asa had made for fear of Baasha king of Israel. Ishmael son of Nethaniah filled it with the slain.

[10] Then Ishmael took captive all the remnant of the people of Mizpah—the daughters of the king along with all the others who remained in Mizpah—over whom Nebuzaradan captain of the guard had appointed Gedaliah son of Ahikam. Ishmael son of Nethaniah took them captive and set off to cross over to the Ammonites. [11] When Johanan son of Kareah and all the commanders of the armies with him heard of all the crimes that Ishmael son of Nethaniah had committed, [12] they took all their men and went to fight Ishmael son of Nethaniah. And they found him near the great pool in Gibeon. [13] When all the people with Ishmael saw Johanan son of Kareah and all the commanders of the army with him, they rejoiced, [14] and all the people whom Ishmael had taken captive at Mizpah turned and went over to Johanan son of Kareah. [15] But Ishmael son of Nethaniah and eight of his men escaped from Johanan and went to the Ammonites. [16] Then Johanan son of Kareah and all the commanders of the armies with him took the whole remnant of the people from Mizpah whom he had recovered from Ishmael son of Nethaniah after Ishmael had killed Gedaliah son of Ahikam: the soldiers, women, children, and court officials he had brought back from Gibeon. [17] And they went and stayed in Geruth Chimham, near Bethlehem, in order to proceed into Egypt [18] to escape the Chaldeans. For they were afraid of the Chaldeans because Ishmael son of Nethaniah had struck down Gedaliah son of Ahikam, whom the king of Babylon had appointed over the land.

42 Then all the commanders of the forces, along with Johanan son of Kareah, Jezaniah son of Hoshaiah, and all the people from the least to the greatest, approached [2] Jeremiah the prophet and said, "May our petition come before you; pray to the LORD your God on behalf of this entire remnant. For few of us remain of the many, as you can see with your own eyes." [3] "Pray that the LORD your God will tell us the way we should walk and the thing we should do." [4] "I have heard you," replied Jeremiah the prophet. "I will surely pray to the LORD your God as you request, and I will tell you everything that the LORD answers; I will not withhold a word from you." [5] Then they said to Jeremiah, "May the LORD be a true and faithful witness against us if we do not act upon every word that the LORD your God sends you to tell us." [6] "Whether it is pleasant or unpleasant, we will obey the voice of the LORD our God to whom we are sending you, so that it may go well with us, for we will obey the voice of the LORD our God!"

[7] After ten days the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah, [8] and he summoned Johanan son of Kareah, all the commanders of the forces who were with him, and all the people from the least to the greatest. [9] Jeremiah told them, "Thus says the LORD, the God of Israel, to whom you sent me to present your petition:" [10] 'If you will indeed stay in this land, then I will build you up and not tear you down; I will plant you and not uproot you, for I will relent of the disaster I have brought upon you.'

[11] Do not be afraid of the king of Babylon, whom you now fear; do not be afraid of him, declares the LORD, for I am with you to save you and deliver you from him. [12] And I will show you compassion, and he will have compassion on you and restore you to your own land.' [13] But if you say, 'We will not stay in this land,' and you thus disobey the voice of the LORD your God, [14] and if you say, 'No, but we will go to the land of Egypt and live there, where we will not see war or hear the sound of the ram's horn or hunger for bread,' [15] then hear the word of the LORD, O remnant of Judah! This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'If you are determined to go to Egypt and reside there,' [16] then the sword you fear will overtake you there, and the famine you dread will follow on your heels into Egypt, and you will die there. [17] So all who resolve to go to Egypt to reside there will die by sword and famine and plague. Not one of them will survive or escape the disaster I will bring upon them.' [18] For this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Just as My anger and wrath were poured out on the residents of Jerusalem, so will My wrath be poured out on you if you go to Egypt. You will become an object of cursing and horror, of vilification and disgrace, and you will never see this place again.' [19] The LORD has told you, O remnant of Judah, 'Do not go to Egypt.' Know for sure that I have warned you today! [20] For you have deceived yourselves by sending me to the LORD your God, saying, 'Pray to the LORD our God on our behalf, and as for all that the LORD our God says, tell it to us and we will do it.' [21] For I have told you today, but you have not obeyed the voice of the LORD your God in all He has sent me to tell you. [22] "Now therefore, know for sure that by sword and famine and plague you will die in the place where you desire to go to reside."

43 When Jeremiah had finished telling all the people all the words of the LORD their God—everything that the LORD had sent him to say— [2] Azariah son of Hoshaiah, Johanan son of Kareah, and all the arrogant men said to Jeremiah, "You are lying! The LORD our God has not sent you to say, 'You must not go to Egypt to reside there.'" [3] "Rather, Baruch son of Neriah is inciting you against us to deliver us into the hands of the Chaldeans, so that they may put us to death or exile us to Babylon!" [4] So Johanan son of Kareah and all the commanders of the forces disobeyed the command of the LORD to stay in the land of Judah. [5] Instead, Johanan son of Kareah and all the commanders of the forces took the whole remnant of Judah, those who had returned to the land of Judah from all the nations to which they had been scattered, [6] the men, the women, the children, the king's daughters, and everyone whom Nebuzaradan captain of the guard had allowed to remain with Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, as well as Jeremiah the prophet and Baruch son of Neriah. [7] So they entered the land of Egypt because they did not obey the voice of the LORD, and they went as far as Tahpanhes. [8] Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah at Tahpanhes: [9] "In the sight of the Jews, pick up some large stones and bury them in the clay of the brick pavement at the entrance to Pharaoh's palace at Tahpanhes." [10] Then tell them that this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'I will send for My servant Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and I will set his throne over these stones that I have embedded, and he will spread his royal pavilion over them.' [11] He will come and strike down the land of Egypt, bringing death to those destined for death, captivity to those destined for captivity, and the sword to those destined for the sword. [12] I will kindle a fire in the temples of the gods of Egypt, and Nebuchadnezzar will burn those temples and take their gods as captives. So he will wrap himself with the land of Egypt as a shepherd wraps himself in his garment, and he will depart from there unscathed. [13] "He will demolish the sacred pillars of the temple of the sun in the land of Egypt, and he will burn down the temples of the gods of Egypt.'"

44 This is the word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the Jews living in the land of Egypt—in Migdol, Tahpanhes, and Memphis—and in the land of Pathros: [2] "This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: You have seen all the disaster that I brought against Jerusalem and all the cities of Judah; and behold, they lie today in ruins and desolation" [3] because of the evil they have done. They provoked Me to anger by continuing to burn incense and to serve other gods that neither they nor you nor your fathers ever knew. [4] Yet I sent you all My servants the prophets again and again, saying: 'Do not do this detestable thing that I hate.' [5] But they did not listen or incline their ears; they did not turn from their wickedness or stop burning incense to other gods. [6] Therefore My wrath and anger poured out and burned in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem, so that they have become the desolate ruin they are today. [7] So now, this is what the LORD God of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: Why are you doing such great harm to yourselves by cutting off from Judah man and woman, child and infant, leaving yourselves without a remnant? [8] Why are you provoking Me to anger by the work of your hands by burning incense to other gods in the land of Egypt, where you have gone to reside? As a result, you will be cut off and will become an object of cursing and reproach among all the nations of the earth. [9] Have you forgotten the wickedness of your fathers and of the kings of Judah and their wives, as well as the wickedness that you and your wives committed in the land of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem?

[10] To this day they have not humbled themselves or shown reverence, nor have they followed My instruction or the statutes that I set before you and your fathers. [11] Therefore this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: I will set My face to bring disaster and to cut off all Judah. [12] And I will take away the remnant of Judah who have resolved to go to the land of Egypt to reside there; they will meet their end. They will all fall by the sword or be consumed by famine. From the least to the greatest, they will die by sword or famine; and they will become an object of cursing and horror, of vilification and reproach. [13] I will punish those who live in the land of Egypt, just as I punished Jerusalem, by sword and famine and plague, [14] "so that none of the remnant of Judah who have gone to reside in Egypt will escape or survive to return to the land of Judah, where they long to return and live; for none will return except a few fugitives."

[15] Then all the men who knew that their wives were burning incense to other gods, and all the women standing by—a great assembly—along with all the people living in the land of Egypt and in Pathros, said to Jeremiah, [16] "As for the word you have spoken to us in the name of the LORD, we will not listen to you!" [17] Instead, we will do everything we vowed to do: We will burn incense to the Queen of Heaven and offer drink offerings to her, just as we, our fathers, our kings, and our officials did in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem. At that time we had plenty of food and good things, and we saw no disaster. [18] "But from the time we stopped burning incense to the Queen of Heaven and pouring out drink offerings to her, we have lacked everything and have been perishing by sword and famine." [19] "Moreover," said the women, "when we burned incense to the Queen of Heaven and poured out drink offerings to her, was it without our husbands' knowledge that we made sacrificial cakes in her image and poured out drink offerings to her?"

[20] Then Jeremiah said to all the people, both men and women, who were answering him, [21] "As for the incense you burned in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem—you, your fathers, your kings, your officials, and the people of the land—did the LORD not remember and bring this to mind?" [22] So the LORD could no longer endure the evil deeds and detestable acts you committed, and your land became a desolation, a horror, and an object of cursing, without inhabitant, as it is this day. [23] "Because you burned incense and sinned against the LORD, and did not obey the voice of the LORD or walk in His instruction, His statutes, and His testimonies, this disaster has befallen you, as you see today." [24] Then Jeremiah said to all the people, including all the women, "Hear the word of the LORD, all those of Judah who are in the land of Egypt." [25] This is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: As for you and your wives, you have spoken with your mouths and fulfilled with your hands your words: 'We will surely perform our vows that we have made to burn incense to the Queen of Heaven and to pour out drink offerings to her.' Go ahead, then, do what you have promised! Keep your vows! [26] Nevertheless, hear the word of the LORD, all you people of Judah living in Egypt: Behold, I have sworn by My great name, says the LORD, that never again will any man of Judah living in the land of Egypt invoke My name or say, 'As surely as the Lord GOD lives.' [27] I am watching over them for harm and not for good, and every man of Judah who is in the land of Egypt will meet his end by sword or famine, until they are finished off. [28] Those who escape the sword will return from Egypt to Judah, few in number, and the whole remnant of Judah who went to dwell in the land of Egypt will know whose word will stand, Mine or theirs! [29] This will be a sign to you that I will punish you in this place, declares the LORD, so that you may know that My threats of harm against you will surely stand. [30] "This is what the LORD says: Behold, I will deliver Pharaoh Hophra king of Egypt into the hands of his enemies who seek his life, just as I delivered Zedekiah king of Judah into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, the enemy who was seeking his life."

45 This is the word that Jeremiah the prophet spoke to Baruch son of Neriah when he wrote these words on a scroll at the dictation of Jeremiah in the fourth year of Jehoiakim son of Josiah, king of Judah: [2] "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says to you, Baruch: [3] "You have said, 'Woe is me because the LORD has added sorrow to my pain! I am worn out with groaning and have found no rest.'" [4] Thus Jeremiah was to say to Baruch: "This is what the LORD says: Throughout the land I will demolish what I have built and uproot what I have planted." [5] "But as for you, do you seek great things for yourself? Stop seeking! For I will bring disaster on every living creature, declares the LORD, but wherever you go, I will grant your life as a spoil of war."

46 This is the word of the LORD about the nations—the word that came to Jeremiah the prophet [2] concerning Egypt and the army of Pharaoh Neco king of Egypt, which was defeated at Carchemish on the Euphrates River by Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah: [3] "Deploy your shields, small and large; advance for battle!" [4] Harness the horses; mount the steeds; take your positions with helmets on! Polish your spears; put on armor! [5] "Why am I seeing this? They are terrified, they are retreating; their warriors are defeated, they flee in haste without looking back; terror is on every side!" declares the LORD. [6] "The swift cannot flee, and the warrior cannot escape! In the north by the River Euphrates they stumble and fall." [7] Who is this, rising like the Nile, like rivers whose waters churn? [8] Egypt rises like the Nile, and its waters churn like rivers, boasting, 'I will rise and cover the earth; I will destroy the cities and their people.'

[9] Advance, O horses! Race furiously, O chariots! Let the warriors come forth—Cush and Put carrying their shields, men of Lydia drawing the bow. [10] For that day belongs to the Lord GOD of Hosts, a day of vengeance against His foes. The sword will devour until it is satisfied, until it is quenched with their blood. For the Lord GOD of Hosts will hold a sacrifice in the land of the north by the River Euphrates. [11] Go up to Gilead for balm, O Virgin Daughter of Egypt! In vain you try many remedies, but for you there is no healing. [12] "The nations have heard of your shame, and your outcry fills the earth, because warrior stumbles over warrior and both of them have fallen together."

[13] This is the word that the LORD spoke to Jeremiah the prophet about the coming of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon to strike the land of Egypt: [14] "Announce it in Egypt, and proclaim it in Migdol; proclaim it in Memphis and Tahpanhes: 'Take your positions and prepare yourself, for the sword devours those around you.'" [15] Why have your warriors been laid low? They cannot stand, for the LORD has thrust them down. [16] They continue to stumble; indeed, they have fallen over one another. They say, 'Get up! Let us return to our people and to the land of our birth, away from the sword of the oppressor.' [17] There they will cry out: 'Pharaoh king of Egypt was all noise; he has let the appointed time pass him by.'

[18] As surely as I live, declares the King, whose name is the LORD of Hosts, there will come one who is like Tabor among the mountains and like Carmel by the sea. [19] Pack your bags for exile, O daughter dwelling in Egypt! For Memphis will be laid waste, destroyed and uninhabited. [20] Egypt is a beautiful heifer, but a gadfly from the north is coming against her. [21] Even the mercenaries among her are like fattened calves. They too will turn back; together they will flee, they will not stand their ground, for the day of calamity is coming upon them— the time of their punishment. [22] Egypt will hiss like a fleeing serpent, for the enemy will advance in force; with axes they

will come against her like woodsmen cutting down trees. [23] They will chop down her forest, declares the LORD, dense though it may be, for they are more numerous than locusts; they cannot be counted. [24] "The Daughter of Egypt will be put to shame; she will be delivered into the hands of the people of the north." [25] The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: "Behold, I am about to punish Amon god of Thebes, along with Pharaoh, Egypt with her gods and kings, and those who trust in Pharaoh." [26] I will deliver them into the hands of those who seek their lives—of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and his officers. But after this, Egypt will be inhabited as in days of old, declares the LORD. [27] But you, O Jacob My servant, do not be afraid, and do not be dismayed, O Israel. For I will surely save you out of a distant place, your descendants from the land of their captivity! Jacob will return to quiet and ease, with no one to make him afraid. [28] "And you, My servant Jacob, do not be afraid, declares the LORD, for I am with you. Though I will completely destroy all the nations to which I have banished you, I will not completely destroy you. Yet I will discipline you justly, and will by no means leave you unpunished."

47 This is the word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah the prophet about the Philistines before Pharaoh struck down Gaza. [2] This is what the LORD says: "See how the waters are rising from the north and becoming an overflowing torrent. They will overflow the land and its fullness, the cities and their inhabitants. The people will cry out, and all who dwell in the land will wail" [3] at the sound of the galloping hooves of stallions, the rumbling of chariots, and the clatter of their wheels. The fathers will not turn back for their sons; their hands will hang limp. [4] For the day has come to destroy all the Philistines, to cut off from Tyre and Sidon every remaining ally. Indeed, the LORD is about to destroy the Philistines, the remnant from the coasts of Caphtor. [5] The people of Gaza will shave their heads in mourning; Ashkelon will be silenced. O remnant of their valley, how long will you gash yourself? [6] 'Alas, O sword of the LORD, how long until you rest? Return to your sheath; cease and be still!' [7] "How can it rest when the LORD has commanded it? He has appointed it against Ashkelon and the shore of its coastland."

48 Concerning Moab, this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: "Woe to Nebo, for it will be devastated. Kiriathaim will be captured and disgraced; the fortress will be shattered and dismantled." [2] There is no longer praise for Moab; in Heshbon they devise evil against her: 'Come, let us cut her off from nationhood.' You too, O people of Madmen, will be silenced; the sword will pursue you. [3] A voice cries out from Horonaim: 'Devastation and great destruction!' [4] Moab will be shattered; her little ones will cry out. [5] For on the ascent to Luhith they weep bitterly as they go, and on the descent to Horonaim cries of distress resound over the destruction: [6] 'Flee! Run for your lives! Become like a juniper in the desert.' [7] Because you trust in your works and treasures, you too will be captured, and Chemosh will go into exile with his priests and officials. [8] The destroyer will move against every city, and not one town will escape. The valley will also be ruined, and the high plain will be destroyed, as the LORD has said. [9] Put salt on Moab, for she will be laid waste; her cities will become desolate, with no one to dwell in them. [10] Cursed is the one who is remiss in doing the work of the LORD, and cursed is he who withholds his sword from bloodshed. [11] Moab has been at ease from youth, settled like wine on its dregs; he has not been poured from vessel to vessel or gone into exile. So his flavor has remained the same, and his aroma is unchanged. [12] Therefore behold, the days are coming, declares the LORD, when I will send to him wanderers, who will pour him out. They will empty his vessels and shatter his jars. [13] Then Moab will be ashamed of Chemosh, just as the house of Israel was ashamed when they trusted in Bethel. [14] How can you say, 'We are warriors, mighty men ready for battle'?

[15] Moab has been destroyed and its towns have been invaded; the best of its young men have gone down in the slaughter, declares the King, whose name is the LORD of Hosts. [16] Moab's calamity is at hand, and his affliction is rushing swiftly. [17] Mourn for him, all you who surround him, everyone who knows his name; tell how the mighty scepter is shattered— the glorious staff! [18] Come down from your glory; sit on parched ground, O daughter dwelling in Dibon, for the destroyer of Moab has come against you; he has destroyed your fortresses. [19] Stand by the road and watch, O dweller of Aroer! Ask the man fleeing or the woman escaping, 'What has happened?'

[20] Moab is put to shame, for it has been shattered. Wail and cry out! Declare by the Arnon that Moab is destroyed. [21] Judgment has come upon the high plain—upon Holon, Jahzah, and Mephaath, [22] upon Dibon, Nebo, and Beth-diblathaim, [23] upon Kiriathaim, Beth-gamul, and Beth-meon, [24] upon Kerioth, Bozrah, and all the towns of Moab, those far and near. [25] "The horn of Moab has been cut off, and his arm is broken," declares the LORD. [26] "Make him drunk, because he has magnified himself against the LORD; so Moab will wallow in his own vomit, and he will also become a laughingstock." [27] Was not Israel your object of ridicule? Was he ever found among thieves? For whenever you speak of him you shake your head. [28] Abandon the towns and settle among the rocks, O dwellers of Moab! Be like a dove that nests at the mouth of a cave. [29] We have heard of Moab's pomposity, his exceeding pride and conceit, his proud arrogance and haughtiness of heart. [30] "I know his insolence," declares the LORD, "but it is futile. His boasting is as empty as his deeds."

[31] Therefore I will wail for Moab; I will cry out for all of Moab; I will moan for the men of Kir-heres. [32] I will weep for you, O vine of Sibmah, more than I weep for Jazer. Your tendrils have extended to the sea; they reach even to Jazer. The destroyer has descended on your summer fruit and grape harvest. [33] Joy and gladness are removed from the orchard and from the fields of Moab. I have stopped the flow of wine from the presses; no one treads them with shouts of joy; their shouts are not for joy. [34] There is a cry from Heshbon to Elealeh; they raise their voices to Jahaz, from Zoar to Horonaim and Eglath-shelishiyah; for even the waters of Nimrim have dried up. [35] In Moab, declares the LORD, I will bring an end to those who make offerings on the high places and burn incense to their gods. [36] Therefore My heart laments like a flute for Moab; it laments like a flute for the men of Kir-heres, because the wealth they acquired has perished. [37] For every head is shaved and every beard is clipped; on every hand is a gash, and around every waist is sackcloth. [38] "On all the rooftops of Moab and in the public squares, everyone is mourning; for I have shattered Moab like an unwanted jar," declares the LORD. [39] "How shattered it is! How they wail! How Moab has turned his back in shame! Moab has become an object of ridicule and horror to all those around him." [40] For this is what the LORD says: "Behold, an eagle swoops down and spreads his wings against Moab." [41] Kirioth has been taken, and the strongholds seized. In that day the heart of Moab's warriors will be like the heart of a woman in labor. [42] Moab will be destroyed as a nation because he vaunted himself against the LORD. [43] "Terror and pit and snare await you, O dweller of Moab," declares the LORD. [44] "Whoever flees the panic will fall into the pit, and whoever climbs from the pit will be caught in the snare. For I will bring upon Moab the year of their punishment," declares the LORD. [45] "Those who flee will stand helpless in Heshbon's shadow, because fire has gone forth from Heshbon and a flame from within Sihon. It devours the foreheads of Moab and the skulls of the sons of tumult." [46] Woe to you, O Moab! The people of Chemosh have perished; for your sons have been taken into exile and your daughters have gone into captivity. [47] "Yet in the latter days I will restore Moab from captivity," declares the LORD. Here ends the judgment on Moab.

49 Concerning the Ammonites, this is what the LORD says: "Has Israel no sons? Is he without heir? Why then has Milcom taken possession of Gad? Why have his people settled in their cities?" [2] Therefore, behold, the days are coming, declares the LORD, when I will sound the battle cry against Rabbah of the Ammonites. It will become a heap of ruins, and its villages will be burned. Then Israel will drive out their dispossessors, says the LORD. [3] Wail, O Heshbon, for Ai has been destroyed; cry out, O daughters of Rabbah! Put on sackcloth and mourn; run back and forth within your walls, for Milcom will go into exile together with his priests and officials. [4] Why do you boast of your valleys— your valleys so fruitful, O faithless daughter? You trust in your riches and say, 'Who can come against me?' [5] Behold, I am about to bring terror upon you, declares the Lord GOD of Hosts, from all those around you. You will each be driven headlong, with no one to regather the fugitives. [6] "Yet afterward I will restore the Ammonites from captivity," declares the LORD. [7] Concerning Edom, this is what the LORD of Hosts says: "Is there no longer wisdom in Teman? Has counsel perished from the prudent? Has their wisdom decayed?" [8] Turn and run! Lie low, O dwellers of Dedan, for I will bring disaster on Esau at the time I punish him. [9] If grape gatherers came to you, would they not leave some gleanings? Were thieves to come in the night, would they not steal only what they wanted? [10] But I will strip Esau bare; I will uncover his hiding places, and he will be unable to conceal himself. His descendants will be destroyed along with his relatives and neighbors, and he will be no more. [11] "Abandon your orphans; I will preserve their lives. Let your widows trust in Me." [12] For this is what the LORD says: "If those who do not deserve to drink the cup must drink it, can you possibly remain unpunished? You will not go unpunished, for you must drink it too."

[13] "For by Myself I have sworn, declares the LORD, that Bozrah will become a desolation, a disgrace, a ruin, and a curse, and all her cities will be in ruins forever." [14] I have heard a message from the LORD; an envoy has been sent to the nations: "Assemble yourselves to march against her! Rise up for battle!" [15] "For behold, I will make you small among nations, despised among men." [16] "The terror you cause and the pride of your heart have deceived you, O dwellers in the clefts of the rocks, O occupiers of the mountain summit. Though you elevate your nest like the eagle, even from there I will bring you down," declares the LORD. [17] "Edom will become an object of horror. All who pass by will be appalled and will scoff at all her wounds." [18] "As Sodom and Gomorrah were overthrown along with their neighbors," says the LORD, "no one will dwell there; no man will abide there."

[19] "Behold, one will come up like a lion from the thickets of the Jordan to the watered pasture. For in an instant I will chase Edom from her land. Who is the chosen one I will appoint for this? For who is like Me, and who can challenge Me? What shepherd can stand against Me?" [20] Therefore hear the plans that the LORD has drawn up against Edom and the strategies He has devised against the people of Teman: Surely the little ones of the flock will be dragged away; certainly their pasture will be made desolate because of them. [21] At the sound of their fall the earth will quake; their cry will resound to the Red Sea. [22] Look! An eagle will soar and swoop down, spreading its wings over Bozrah. In that day the hearts of Edom's mighty men will be like the heart of a woman in labor. [23] Concerning Damascus:

"Hamath and Arpad are put to shame, for they have heard a bad report; they are agitated like the sea; their anxiety cannot be calmed." [24] Damascus has become feeble; she has turned to flee. Panic has gripped her; anguish and pain have seized her like a woman in labor. [25] How is the city of praise not forsaken, the town that brings Me joy?

[26] "For her young men will fall in the streets, and all her warriors will be silenced in that day," declares the LORD of Hosts. [27] "I will set fire to the walls of Damascus; it will consume the fortresses of Ben-hadad." [28] Concerning Kedar and the kingdoms of Hazor, which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon defeated, this is what the LORD says: "Rise up, advance against Kedar, and destroy the people of the east!" [29] They will take their tents and flocks, their tent curtains and all their goods. They will take their camels for themselves. They will shout to them: 'Terror is on every side!' [30] "Run! Escape quickly! Lie low, O residents of Hazor," declares the LORD, "for Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon has drawn up a plan against you; he has devised a strategy against you." [31] "Rise up, advance against a nation at ease, one that dwells securely," declares the LORD. "They have no gates or bars; they live alone." [32] "Their camels will become plunder, and their large herds will be spoil. I will scatter to the wind in every direction those who shave their temples; I will bring calamity on them from all sides," declares the LORD. [33] "Hazor will become a haunt for jackals, a desolation forever. No one will dwell there; no man will abide there." [34] This is the word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah the prophet concerning Elam at the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah. [35] This is what the LORD of Hosts says: "Behold, I will shatter Elam's bow, the mainstay of their might." [36] I will bring the four winds against Elam from the four corners of the heavens, and I will scatter them to all these winds. There will not be a nation to which Elam's exiles will not go. [37] "So I will shatter Elam before their foes, before those who seek their lives. I will bring disaster upon them, even My fierce anger," declares the LORD. "I will send out the sword after them until I finish them off." [38] "I will set My throne in Elam, and destroy its king and officials," declares the LORD. [39] "Yet in the last days, I will restore Elam from captivity," declares the LORD.

50 This is the word that the LORD spoke through Jeremiah the prophet concerning Babylon and the land of the Chaldeans: [2] "Announce and declare to the nations; lift up a banner and proclaim it; hold nothing back when you say, 'Babylon is captured; Bel is put to shame; Marduk is shattered, her images are disgraced, her idols are broken in pieces.'" [3] "For a nation from the north will come against her; it will make her land a desolation. No one will live in it; both man and beast will flee." [4] "In those days and at that time, declares the LORD, the children of Israel and the children of Judah will come together, weeping as they come, and will seek the LORD their God." [5] They will ask the way to Zion and turn their faces toward it. They will come and join themselves to the LORD in an everlasting covenant that will never be forgotten. [6] My people are lost sheep; their shepherds have led them astray, causing them to roam the mountains. They have wandered from mountain to hill; they have forgotten their resting place. [7] All who found them devoured them, and their enemies said, 'We are not guilty, for they have sinned against the LORD, their true pasture, the LORD, the hope of their fathers.' [8] Flee from the midst of Babylon; depart from the land of the Chaldeans; be like the he-goats that lead the flock. [9] For behold, I stir up and bring against Babylon an assembly of great nations from the land of the north. They will line up against her; from the north she will be captured. Their arrows will be like skilled warriors who do not return empty-handed. [10] "Chaldea will be plundered; all who plunder her will have their fill," declares the LORD. [11] "Because you rejoice, because you sing in triumph — you who plunder My inheritance— because you frolic like a heifer treading grain and neigh like stallions," [12] your mother will be greatly ashamed; she who bore you will be disgraced. Behold, she will be the least of the nations, a wilderness, a dry land, and a desert. [13] Because of the wrath of the LORD, she will not be inhabited; she will become completely desolate. All who pass through Babylon will be horrified and will hiss at all her wounds. [14] Line up in formation around Babylon, all you who draw the bow! Shoot at her! Spare no arrows! For she has sinned against the LORD.

[15] Raise a war cry against her on every side! She has thrown up her hands in surrender; her towers have fallen; her walls are torn down. Since this is the vengeance of the LORD, take out your vengeance upon her; as she has done, do the same to her. [16] Cut off the sower from Babylon, and the one who wields the sickle at harvest time. In the face of the oppressor's sword, each will turn to his own people, each will flee to his own land. [17] "Israel is a scattered flock, chased away by lions. The first to devour him was the king of Assyria; the last to crush his bones was Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon." [18] Therefore this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: "I will punish the king of Babylon and his land as I punished the king of Assyria." [19] I will return Israel to his pasture, and he will graze on Carmel and Bashan; his soul will be satisfied on the hills of Ephraim and Gilead. [20] In those days and at that time, declares the LORD, a search will be made for Israel's guilt, but there will be none, and for Judah's sins, but they will not be found; for I will forgive the remnant I preserve. [21] "Go up against the land of Merathaim, and against the residents of Pekod. Kill them and devote them to destruction. Do all that I have commanded you," declares the LORD. [22] "The noise of battle is in the land— the noise of great destruction." [23] How the hammer of the whole earth lies broken and shattered! What a horror Babylon has become among the nations! [24] I laid a snare for you, O Babylon, and you were caught before you knew it. You were found and captured because you challenged the LORD. [25] The LORD has opened His armory and brought out His weapons of wrath, for this is the work of the Lord GOD of Hosts in the land of the Chaldeans. [26] Come against her from the farthest border. Break open her granaries; pile her up like mounds of grain. Devote her to destruction; leave her no survivors. [27] Kill all her young bulls; let them go down to the slaughter. Woe to them, for their day has come— the time of their punishment. [28] Listen to the fugitives and refugees from the land of Babylon, declaring in Zion the vengeance of the LORD our God, the vengeance for His temple. [29] Summon the archers against Babylon, all who string the bow. Encamp all around her; let no one escape. Repay her according to her deeds; do to her as she has done. For she has defied the LORD, the Holy One of Israel.

[30] "Therefore, her young men will fall in the streets, and all her warriors will be silenced in that day," declares the LORD.

[31] "Behold, I am against you, O arrogant one," declares the Lord GOD of Hosts, "for your day has come, the time when I will punish you." [32] "The arrogant one will stumble and fall with no one to pick him up. And I will kindle a fire in his cities to consume all those around him." [33] This is what the LORD of Hosts says: "The sons of Israel are oppressed, and the sons of Judah as well. All their captors hold them fast, refusing to release them." [34] Their Redeemer is strong; the LORD of Hosts is His name. He will fervently plead their case so that He may bring rest to the earth, but turmoil to those who live in Babylon. [35] A sword is against the Chaldeans, declares the LORD, against those who live in Babylon, and against her officials and wise men. [36] A sword is against her false prophets, and they will become fools. A sword is against her warriors, and they will be filled with terror. [37] A sword is against her horses and chariots and against all the foreigners in her midst, and they will become like women. A sword is against her treasuries, and they will be plundered. [38] A drought is upon her waters, and they will be dried up. For it is a land of graven images, and the people go mad over idols. [39] So the desert creatures and hyenas will live there and ostriches will dwell there. It will never again be inhabited or lived in from generation to generation. [40] "As God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah along with their neighbors," declares the LORD, "no one will dwell there; no man will abide there." [41] Behold, an army is coming from the north; a great nation and many kings are stirred up from the ends of the earth. [42] They grasp the bow and spear; they are cruel and merciless. Their voice roars like the sea, and they ride upon horses, lined up like men in formation against you, O Daughter of Babylon. [43] The king of Babylon has heard the report, and his hands hang limp. Anguish has gripped him, pain like that of a woman in labor. [44] "Behold, one will come up like a lion from the thickets of the Jordan to the watered pasture. For in an instant I will chase Babylon from her land. Who is the chosen one I will appoint for this? For who is like Me, and who can challenge Me? What shepherd can stand against Me?" [45] Therefore hear the plans that the LORD has drawn up against Babylon and the strategies He has devised against the land of the Chaldeans: Surely the little ones of the flock will be dragged away; certainly their pasture will be made desolate because of them. [46] At the sound of Babylon's capture the earth will quake; a cry will be heard among the nations.

51 This is what the LORD says: "Behold, I will stir up against Babylon and against the people of Leb-kamai the spirit of a destroyer." [2] I will send strangers to Babylon to winnow her and empty her land; for they will come against her from every side in her day of disaster. [3] Do not let the archer bend his bow or put on his armor. Do not spare her young men; devote all her army to destruction! [4] And they will fall slain in the land of the Chaldeans, and pierced through in her streets. [5] "For Israel and Judah have not been abandoned by their God, the LORD of Hosts, though their land is full of guilt before the Holy One of Israel." [6] Flee from Babylon! Escape with your lives! Do not be destroyed in her punishment. For this is the time of the LORD's vengeance; He will pay her what she deserves. [7] Babylon was a gold cup in the hand of the LORD, making the whole earth drunk. The nations drank her wine; therefore the nations have gone mad. [8] Suddenly Babylon has fallen and been shattered. Wail for her; get her balm for her pain; perhaps she can be healed. [9] "We tried to heal Babylon, but she could not be healed. Abandon her! Let each of us go to his own land, for her judgment extends to the sky and reaches to the clouds." [10] "The LORD has brought forth our vindication; come, let us tell in Zion what the LORD our God has accomplished." [11] Sharpen the arrows! Fill the quivers! The LORD has aroused the spirit of the kings of the Medes, because His plan is aimed at Babylon to destroy her, for it is the vengeance of the LORD— vengeance for His temple. [12] Raise a banner against the walls of Babylon; post the guard; station the watchmen; prepare the ambush. For the LORD has both devised and accomplished what He spoke against the people of Babylon. [13] You who dwell by many waters, rich in treasures, your end has come; the thread of your life is cut. [14] The LORD of Hosts has sworn by Himself: "Surely I will fill you up with men as with locusts, and they will shout in triumph over you." [15] The LORD made the earth by His power; He established the world by His wisdom and stretched out the heavens by His understanding. [16] When He thunders, the waters in the heavens roar; He causes the clouds to rise from the ends of the earth. He generates the

lightning with the rain and brings forth the wind from His storehouses. [17] Every man is senseless and devoid of knowledge; every goldsmith is put to shame by his idols. For his molten images are a fraud, and there is no breath in them. [18] They are worthless, a work to be mocked. In the time of their punishment they will perish. [19] The Portion of Jacob is not like these, for He is the Maker of all things, and of the tribe of His inheritance— the LORD of Hosts is His name. [20] "You are My war club, My weapon for battle. With you I shatter nations; with you I bring kingdoms to ruin."

[21] With you I shatter the horse and rider; with you I shatter the chariot and driver. [22] With you I shatter man and woman; with you I shatter the old man and the youth; with you I shatter the young man and the maiden. [23] With you I shatter the shepherd and his flock; with you I shatter the farmer and his oxen; with you I shatter the governors and officials. [24] "Before your very eyes I will repay Babylon and all the dwellers of Chaldea for all the evil they have done in Zion," declares the LORD. [25] "Behold, I am against you, O destroying mountain, you who devastate the whole earth, declares the LORD. I will stretch out My hand against you; I will roll you over the cliffs and turn you into a charred mountain." [26] "No one shall retrieve from you a cornerstone or a foundation stone, because you will become desolate forever," declares the LORD.

[27] "Raise a banner in the land! Blow the ram's horn among the nations! Prepare the nations against her. Summon the kingdoms against her— Ararat, Minni, and Ashkenaz. Appoint a captain against her; bring up horses like swarming locusts." [28] Prepare the nations for battle against her— the kings of the Medes, their governors and all their officials, and all the lands they rule. [29] The earth quakes and writhes because the LORD's intentions against Babylon stand: to make the land of Babylon a desolation, without inhabitant. [30] The warriors of Babylon have stopped fighting; they sit in their strongholds. Their strength is exhausted; they have become like women. Babylon's homes have been set ablaze, the bars of her gates are broken. [31] One courier races to meet another, and messenger follows messenger, to announce to the king of Babylon that his city has been captured from end to end. [32] "The fords have been seized, the marshes set on fire, and the soldiers are terrified." [33] For this is what the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: "The Daughter of Babylon is like a threshing floor at the time it is trampled. In just a little while her harvest time will come." [34] "Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon has devoured me; he has crushed me. He has set me aside like an empty vessel; he has swallowed me like a monster; he filled his belly with my delicacies and vomited me out." [35] "May the violence done to me and to my flesh be upon Babylon," says the dweller of Zion. "May my blood be on the dwellers of Chaldea," says Jerusalem. [36] Therefore this is what the LORD says: "Behold, I will plead your case and take vengeance on your behalf; I will dry up her sea and make her springs run dry." [37] Babylon will become a heap of rubble, a haunt for jackals, an object of horror and scorn, without inhabitant. [38] They will roar together like young lions; they will growl like lion cubs. [39] While they are flushed with heat, I will serve them a feast, and I will make them drunk so that they may revel; then they will fall asleep forever and never wake up, declares the LORD. [40] I will bring them down like lambs to the slaughter, like rams with male goats. [41] How Sheshach has been captured! The praise of all the earth has been seized. What a horror Babylon has become among the nations!

[42] The sea has come up over Babylon; she is covered in turbulent waves. [43] Her cities have become a desolation, a dry and arid land, a land where no one lives, where no son of man passes through. [44] I will punish Bel in Babylon. I will make him spew out what he swallowed. The nations will no longer stream to him; even the wall of Babylon will fall. [45] Come out of her, My people! Save your lives, each of you, from the fierce anger of the LORD. [46] Do not let your heart grow faint, and do not be afraid when the rumor is heard in the land; for a rumor will come one year— and then another the next year— of violence in the land and of ruler against ruler. [47] Therefore, behold, the days are coming when I will punish the idols of Babylon. Her entire land will suffer shame, and all her slain will lie fallen within her. [48] "Then heaven and earth and all that is in them will shout for joy over Babylon because the destroyers from the north will come against her," declares the LORD. [49] "Babylon must fall on account of the slain of Israel, just as the slain of all the earth have fallen because of Babylon." [50] "You who have escaped the sword, depart and do not linger! Remember the LORD from far away, and let Jerusalem come to mind." [51] "We are ashamed because we have heard reproach; disgrace has covered our faces, because foreigners have entered the holy places of the LORD's house." [52] "Therefore, behold, the days are coming," declares the LORD, "when I will punish her idols, and throughout her land the wounded will groan." [53] "Even if Babylon ascends to the heavens and fortifies her lofty stronghold, the destroyers I send will come against her," declares the LORD. [54] "The sound of a cry comes from Babylon, the sound of great destruction from the land of the Chaldeans!" [55] For the LORD will destroy Babylon; He will silence her mighty voice. The waves will roar like great waters; the tumult of their voices will resound. [56] For a destroyer is coming against her— against Babylon. Her warriors will be captured, and their bows will be broken, for the LORD is a God of retribution; He will repay in full. [57] "I will make her princes and wise men drunk, along with her governors, officials, and warriors. Then they will fall asleep forever and not wake up," declares the King, whose name is the LORD of Hosts. [58] This is what the LORD of Hosts says: "Babylon's thick walls will be leveled, and her high gates consumed by fire. So the labor of the people will be for nothing; the nations will exhaust themselves to fuel the flames." [59] This is the message that Jeremiah the prophet gave to the quartermaster Seraiah son of Neriah, the son of Mahseiah, when he went to Babylon with King Zedekiah of Judah in the fourth year of Zedekiah's reign. [60] Jeremiah had written on a single scroll about all the disaster that would come upon Babylon—all these words that had been written concerning Babylon. [61] And Jeremiah said to Seraiah, "When you get to Babylon, see that you read all these words aloud," [62] and say, 'O LORD, You have promised to cut off this place so that no one will remain—neither man nor beast. Indeed, it will be desolate forever.' [63] When you finish reading this scroll, tie a stone to it and cast it into the Euphrates. [64] "Then you are to say, 'In the same way Babylon will sink and never rise again, because of the disaster I will bring upon her. And her people will grow weary.'" Here end the words of Jeremiah.

52 Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem eleven years. His mother's name was Hamutal daughter of Jeremiah; she was from Libnah. [2] And Zedekiah did evil in the sight of the LORD, just as Jehoiakim had done. [3] For because of the anger of the LORD, all this happened in Jerusalem and Judah, until He finally banished them from His presence. And Zedekiah also rebelled against the king of Babylon. [4] So in the ninth year of Zedekiah's reign, on the tenth day of the tenth month, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon marched against Jerusalem with his entire army. They encamped outside the city and built a siege wall all around it. [5] And the city was kept under siege until King Zedekiah's eleventh year. [6] By the ninth day of the fourth month, the famine in the city was so severe that the people of the land had no food. [7] Then the city was breached; and though the Chaldeans had surrounded the city, all the men of war fled the city by night by way of the gate between the two walls near the king's garden. They headed toward the Arabah, [8] but the army of the Chaldeans pursued the king and overtook Zedekiah in the plains of Jericho, and all his army was separated from him. [9] The Chaldeans seized the king and brought him up to the king of Babylon at Riblah in the land of Hamath, where he pronounced judgment on Zedekiah. [10] There at Riblah the king of Babylon slaughtered the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes, and he also killed all the officials of Judah.

[11] Then he put out Zedekiah's eyes, bound him with bronze shackles, and took him to Babylon, where he kept him in custody until his dying day. [12] On the tenth day of the fifth month, in the nineteenth year of Nebuchadnezzar's reign over Babylon, Nebuzaradan captain of the guard, a servant of the king of Babylon, entered Jerusalem. [13] He burned down the house of the LORD, the royal palace, and all the houses of Jerusalem—every significant building. [14] And the whole army of the Chaldeans under the captain of the guard broke down all the walls around Jerusalem.

[15] Then Nebuzaradan captain of the guard carried into exile some of the poorest people and those who remained in the city, along with the deserters who had defected to the king of Babylon and the rest of the craftsmen. [16] But Nebuzaradan captain of the guard left behind some of the poorest of the land to tend the vineyards and fields. [17] Moreover, the Chaldeans broke up the bronze pillars and stands and the bronze Sea in the house of the LORD, and they carried all the bronze to Babylon. [18] They also took away the pots, shovels, wick trimmers, sprinkling bowls, dishes, and all the articles of bronze used in the temple service. [19] The captain of the guard also took away the basins, censers, sprinkling bowls, pots, lampstands, pans, and drink offering bowls—anything made of pure gold or fine silver. [20] As for the two pillars, the Sea, the twelve bronze bulls under it, and the movable stands that King Solomon had made for the house of the LORD, the weight of the bronze from all these articles was beyond measure. [21] Each pillar was eighteen cubits tall and twelve cubits in circumference; each was hollow, four fingers thick.

[22] The bronze capital atop one pillar was five cubits high, with a network of bronze pomegranates all around. The second pillar, with its pomegranates, was similar. [23] Each capital had ninety-six pomegranates on the sides, and a total of a hundred pomegranates were above the surrounding network. [24] The captain of the guard also took away Seraiah the chief priest, Zephaniah the priest of second rank, and the three doorkeepers. [25] Of those still in the city, he took a court official who had been appointed over the men of war, as well as seven trusted royal advisers. He also took the scribe of the captain of the army, who had enlisted the people of the land, and sixty men who were found in the city. [26] Nebuzaradan captain of the guard took them and brought them to the king of Babylon at Riblah. [27] There at Riblah in the land of Hamath, the king of Babylon struck them down and put them to death. So Judah was taken into exile, away from its own land. [28] These are the people Nebuchadnezzar carried away: in the seventh year, 3,023 Jews; [29] in Nebuchadnezzar's eighteenth year, 832 people from Jerusalem; [30] in Nebuchadnezzar's twenty-third year, Nebuzaradan captain of the guard carried away 745 Jews. So in all, 4,600 people were taken away. [31] On the twenty-fifth day of the twelfth month of the thirty-seventh year of the exile of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in the first year of the reign of Evil-merodach king of Babylon, he pardoned Jehoiachin king of Judah and released him from prison. [32] And he spoke kindly to Jehoiachin and set his throne above the thrones of the other kings who were with him in Babylon. [33] So Jehoiachin changed out of his prison clothes, and he

dined regularly at the king's table for the rest of his life. [34] And the king of Babylon
provided Jehoiachin a daily portion for the rest of his life, until the day of his death.

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